

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 5
 ♥ K 9 8 5 2
 ♦ J 5 2
 ♣ 10 9 6 3

♠ A J 10 8 3

♥ A 3

♦ A 9 7

♣ A Q 5



♠ Q 2

♥ Q J 10 7

♦ Q 8 6 4

♣ J 7 4

♠ K 9 7 6 4

♥ 6 4

♦ K 10 3

♣ K 8 2

West

North

East

South

1 ♠

Pass

3 ♠

Pass

6 ♠

All Pass

6 ♠ by North

North is to play 6 ♠. East leads the ♥ Q.

This ♦ holding is the third example shown in the introduction.

This is another follow-up to Deal 1. But this time you are missing both the ♦ Q and ♦ J. In this case an Elimination play doesn't give you a guarantee, it just improves your odds.

Win the first trick and play ♠ A, ♠ K. Trumps split 2-1.

Play three rounds of ♣ s to eliminate the suit from you and dummy.

Now execute the throw-in by leading a ♥ from either hand.

The defender who gets thrown in cannot play a ♥ or a ♣ without handing you the contract by way of a ruff-and-sluff. So he must lead a ♦. Suppose it is East who leads the ♦. You play low in dummy and West must play either the ♦ Q or ♦ J to keep you from getting a cheap trick with your ♦ 9. So you take West's honor with your ♦ A and then finesse East for the other honor. As long as the ♦ Q and ♦ J are in different hands the elimination play will succeed.

Against good defenders there is no way you can make all three ♦ tricks if you make the first play in the suit. This assumes that if one defender held both the ♦ Q and ♦ J he would "split" the honors if you tried to lead through them.

By forcing them to start the ♦ s you make three tricks when the two outstanding honors are divided.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K J 4

♥ 10 5

♦ J 10 9 3 2

♣ Q 7 4

♠ 9 7 3

♥ K J 8 2

♦ A 8 4

♣ K 10 3



♠ A Q 10 2

♥ 6 4

♦ Q 7 5

♣ 9 8 6 2

♠ 8 6 5

♥ A Q 9 7 3

♦ K 6

♣ A J 5

West

North

East

South

Pass

3♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

Using elimination plays makes you a better player. But in Bridge, no matter how skillful you are, there will always be a luck factor.

Here you were lucky the defense didn't start by taking their three ♠s. If they had, you would not have been able to pull off the throw-in, and would have had to try your luck with guessing who had the ♣Q.

South is to play 4♥. West leads the ♦J.

With three unavoidable ♠ losers you cannot afford to lose a ♣. So you either have to guess the location of the ♣Q or (DRUMROLL) pull off an elimination play! Win the ♦K, then pull trumps, it takes two rounds.

Next you eliminate the ♦s by playing ♦A then ruffing the ♦8.

Execute the throw-in by leading a ♠.

The defense is in with a ♠ and they are welcome to take two more ♠s. But then they will have to play a ♠ or a ♦, giving you a ruff-sluff, or else lead a ♣ which finds the ♣Q for you.